

COURSE NOTES

Applied Abstract Algebra Quiver Theory

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Chapter 1

Lecture 1

Course Information

Main topic: Representation theory of quivers.

Office hours: During Mon-Wed: 9:00-16:00, we can discuss for 2 hours of office hours.

Main book: *Ralf Schiffler, Quiver Representations*, Cambridge University Press.

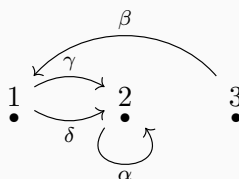
References:

- *Assem, Simons, Skowronski, Elements of the Representation Theory of Associative Algebras*, Cambridge University Press.
- *Coelho, modules, algebras and quivers*.
- *Michel Brion, Representations of quivers*.
- *Henning Krause, Representations of quivers via reflection functor*.
- *W.Crawley-Boevey, Lectures on representations of quivers*.
- *W.Crawley-Boevey, More on representations of quivers*.
- Other Reference: www.math.uni-bielefeld.de

1.1 Introduction

Definition 1.1.1. A quiver Q is a quadruple (Q_0, Q_1, s, t) , where Q_0 is a set of vertices, Q_1 is a set of arrows, and $s, t : Q_1 \rightarrow Q_0$ are two maps. For any arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$, $s(\alpha)$ is called the source of α and $t(\alpha)$ is called the target of α . For example, if $\alpha : 1 \rightarrow 2$, then $s(\alpha) = 1$ and $t(\alpha) = 2$.

Example 1.1.2. Let $Q_0 = \{1, 2, 3\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta\}$. We have $s(\alpha) = 2, t(\alpha) = 2$; $s(\beta) = 3, t(\beta) = 1$; $s(\gamma) = s(\delta) = 1, t(\gamma) = t(\delta) = 2$.

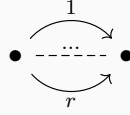


Let path $\xi = \alpha\gamma\beta$, then we have $s(\xi) = s(\beta) = 3$ and $t(\xi) = t(\alpha) = 2$.

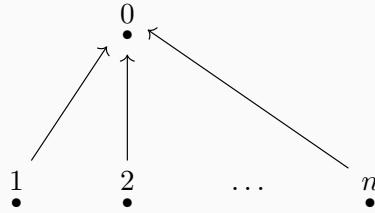
Example 1.1.3. *Jordan quiver.* The Jordan quiver consists of a single vertex and a single arrow starting and ending at this vertex. Formally, $Q_0 = \{1\}$ and $Q_1 = \{\alpha\}$ with $s(\alpha) = t(\alpha) = 1$. It is called the Jordan quiver because its representations correspond to vector spaces equipped with a linear endomorphism. The classification of such representations up to isomorphism is equivalent to the classification of square matrices up to similarity, which is given by the Jordan normal form theorem (over an algebraically closed field).



Example 1.1.4. *r-Kronecker quiver.* The r-Kronecker quiver has two vertices, say 1 and 2, and r arrows $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r$ from 1 to 2. Thus $Q_0 = \{1, 2\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r\}$, with $s(\alpha_i) = 1$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 2$ for all $i = 1, \dots, r$. It is named after Leopold Kronecker. In the case $r = 2$, the representations correspond to pairs of linear maps between two vector spaces, which can be represented by matrix pencils. Kronecker solved the classification problem for these pencils.



Example 1.1.5. *n-subspace quiver.* The n-subspace quiver consists of $n + 1$ vertices $\{0, 1, \dots, n\}$ and n arrows $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ such that $s(\alpha_i) = i$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 0$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$. It is called the n-subspace quiver because its representations are related to configurations of subspaces. If the linear maps associated with the arrows are injective, a representation corresponds to a collection of n subspaces of the vector space associated with the central vertex.

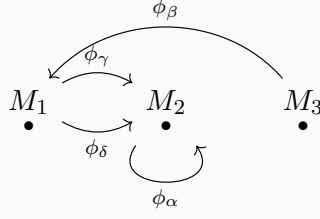


Example 1.1.6. *Finite quivers.* A quiver $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ is called finite if both the set of vertices Q_0 and the set of arrows Q_1 are finite sets.

For the base field we assume $k = \bar{k}$. Usually we take $k = \mathbb{C}$.

Definition 1.1.7. A representation M of a quiver Q consists of a vector space M_i for each vertex $i \in Q_0$ and a linear map $\phi_\alpha : M_{s(\alpha)} \rightarrow M_{t(\alpha)}$ for each arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$. We denote this representation by $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$.

Example 1.1.8. For example 1:



Definition 1.1.9. A representation M is called **finite dimensional** if $\dim M_i < \infty$ for all $i \in Q_0$. The tuple $\dim M = \{\dim M_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ is called the **dimension vector** of M . An element $m \in M$ is a tuple $\{m_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ where $m_i \in M_i$ for each $i \in Q_0$.

Example 1.1.10. 1-Kronecker quiver:

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Take k to be a field. Some representations of this quiver are:

$$M : k \xrightarrow{1} k \quad M' : k \xrightarrow{0} k \quad M'' : k \xrightarrow{0} 0$$

Another example is

$$\widetilde{M} : k^2 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}} k^3 .$$

For $v = (1, 0) \in k^2$, we have

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} .$$

Definition 1.1.11 (Morphism between two representations of Q). Let $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ be two representations of Q . A morphism $f : M \rightarrow N$ is a collection of linear maps $f_i : M_i \rightarrow N_i$ such that for every $\phi_\alpha : M_i \rightarrow M_j$, $\alpha \in Q_1$ the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} M_i & \xrightarrow{\phi_\alpha} & M_j \\ f_i \downarrow & & \downarrow f_j \\ N_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha} & N_j \end{array}$$

Example 1.1.12. In example of 1-Kronecker quiver, let $f : M \rightarrow M''$, $f_1 : k \rightarrow k$ such that $f_1(1) = a$, and $f_2 : k \rightarrow 0$ is the zero map. We can check that f is a

morphism. Check the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & k & \xrightarrow{1} & k & \\ f_1 & \downarrow a & & \downarrow 0 & f_2 \\ & k & \xrightarrow{0} & 0 & \end{array}$$

Now we establish $g : M'' \rightarrow M$. If g is a morphism, then we have $g_1 : k \rightarrow k$ such that $g_1(1) = b$, and $g_2 : 0 \rightarrow k$ is the zero map. To make the target diagram commute it forces $g_1 = 0$. Hence there are only 0 morphism form M'' to M .

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & k & \xrightarrow{0} & 0 & \\ g_1 & \downarrow b & & \downarrow 0 & g_2 \\ & k & \xrightarrow{1} & 0 & \end{array}$$

$$1 \circ g_1 = 0 \Rightarrow g_1 = 0$$

Recall the definition of category:

Definition 1.1.13. A category $\mathcal{C}$ consists of the following data:

- A class of objects, denoted by $\text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$.
- For any pair of objects $X, Y \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, a set of morphisms from X to Y , denoted by $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$. If $f \in \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$, we write $f : X \rightarrow Y$.
- For any three objects $X, Y, Z \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, a composition map:

$$\circ : \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(Y, Z) \times \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Z), \quad (g, f) \mapsto g \circ f.$$

These data must satisfy the following axioms:

1. **Associativity:** For any morphisms $f : X \rightarrow Y$, $g : Y \rightarrow Z$, and $h : Z \rightarrow W$, we have

$$h \circ (g \circ f) = (h \circ g) \circ f.$$

2. **Identity:** For every object $X \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, there exists an identity morphism $\text{id}_X \in \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, X)$ such that for any $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Z \rightarrow X$,

$$f \circ \text{id}_X = f \quad \text{and} \quad \text{id}_X \circ g = g.$$

Denote $\text{Rep}Q$ the category of representations of Q . Then $\text{Ob}(\text{Rep}Q)$ is the class of representations of Q : $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$, and $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}$ is the class of morphisms $\text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ from M to N .

Let $M, N \in \text{Ob}(\text{Rep}Q)$. Then $\text{Hom}(M, N) := \text{Hom}_{\text{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ is a vector space over k with operations defined component-wise: for $f, g \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$ and $\lambda \in k$, let $(f + g)_i = f_i + g_i$ and $(\lambda f)_i = \lambda f_i$ for all $i \in Q_0$.

Verification: Let $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. Since f, g are morphisms, for any arrow $\alpha : i \rightarrow j$, we have $\psi_\alpha f_i = f_j \phi_\alpha$ and $\psi_\alpha g_i = g_j \phi_\alpha$.

1. Addition:

$$\psi_\alpha(f + g)_i = \psi_\alpha(f_i + g_i) = \psi_\alpha f_i + \psi_\alpha g_i = f_j \phi_\alpha + g_j \phi_\alpha = (f_j + g_j) \phi_\alpha = (f + g)_j \phi_\alpha.$$

Thus $f + g \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$.

2. Scalar Multiplication:

$$\psi_\alpha(\lambda f)_i = \psi_\alpha(\lambda f_i) = \lambda(\psi_\alpha f_i) = \lambda(f_j \phi_\alpha) = (\lambda f_j) \phi_\alpha = (\lambda f)_j \phi_\alpha.$$

Thus $\lambda f \in \text{Hom}(M, N)$.

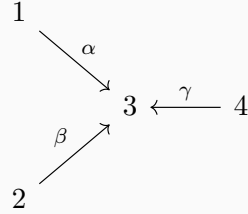
The zero morphism $0 = (0)_{i \in Q_0}$ clearly satisfies the commutativity condition. The vector space axioms follow from the structure of linear maps between vector spaces.

Example 1.1.14. Consider

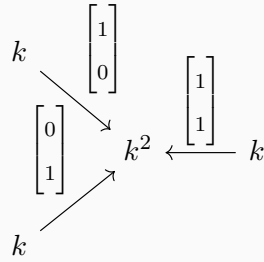
$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

$$\text{Hom}(M, M'') = \{(a, 0) | a \in k\} \simeq k. \quad \text{Hom}(M'', M) = \{0\}.$$

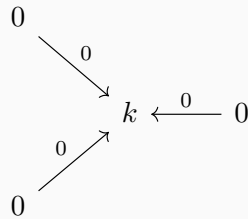
Example 1.1.15. Let Q be a quiver:



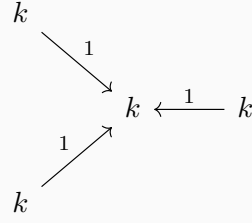
Let M :



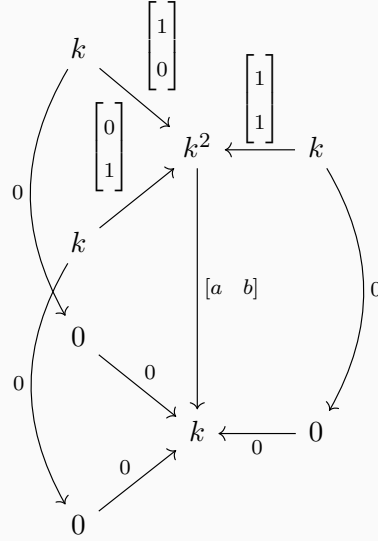
M' :



M'' :



Let us check $\text{Hom}(M, M')$:

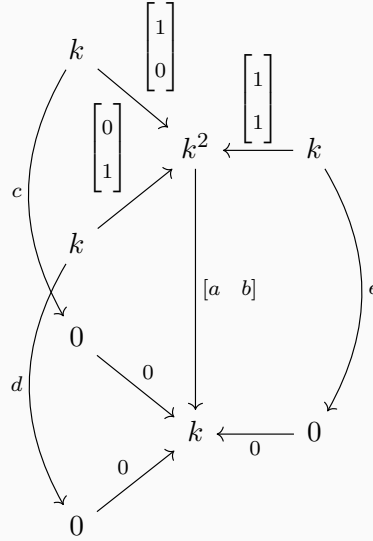


Since $M'_1 = M'_2 = M'_4 = 0$, the maps f_1, f_2, f_4 are zero. Let $f_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. The commutativity conditions impose:

$$\begin{cases} f_3 \phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha f_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies a = 0, \\ f_3 \phi_\beta = \psi_\beta f_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies b = 0. \end{cases}$$

Thus $f_3 = 0$, and $\text{Hom}(M, M') = 0$.

Let us check $\text{Hom}(M, M'')$:

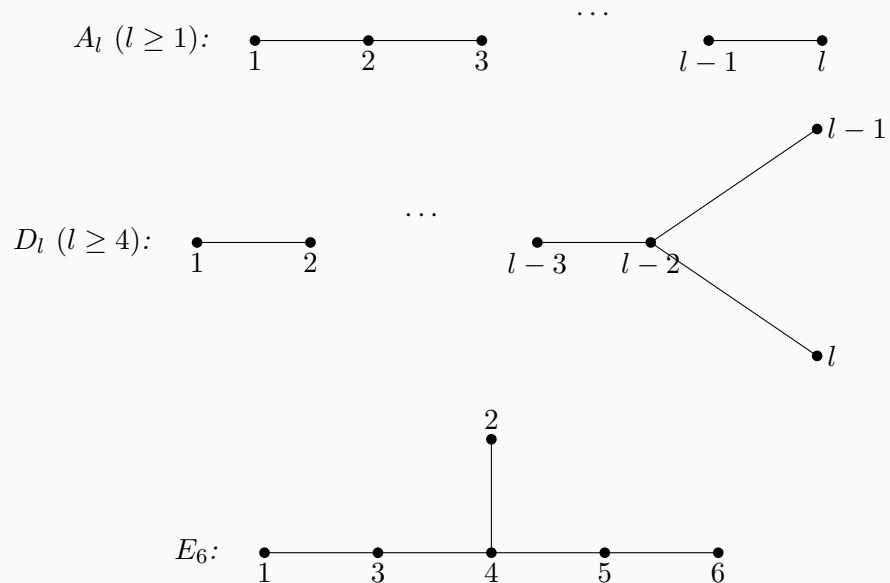


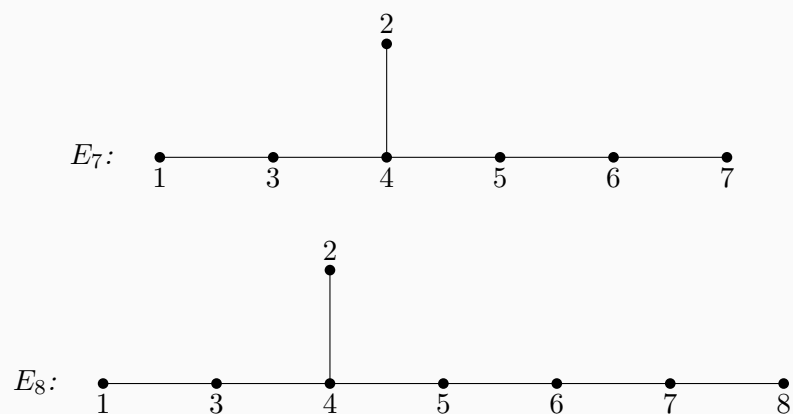
Let the morphism be given by $g_1 = [c]$, $g_2 = [d]$, $g_4 = [e]$, and $g_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. The commutativity conditions are:

$$\begin{cases} g_3 \phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha g_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = c \implies a = c, \\ g_3 \phi_\beta = \psi_\beta g_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = d \implies b = d, \\ g_3 \phi_\gamma = \psi_\gamma g_4 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = e \implies a + b = e. \end{cases}$$

The morphism is uniquely determined by the parameters $a, b \in k$. Hence $\text{Hom}(M, M'') \cong k^2$.

Example 1.1.16. *Dynkin Diagrams:*

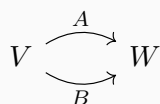




Example 1.1.17. *2-Kronecker quiver:*



Representations of this quiver:



Example 1.1.18. *Jordan quiver:*



Representations of this quiver:



$A : V \rightarrow V$, the matrix representation of A is similar to a Jordan normal form (when $k = \bar{k}$).